

Career Transition Coaching Workbook

A self-coaching workbook covering identity, values, skills, options, and action planning — work through it in order; each section builds on the one before it.

Career transitions are genuinely disorienting, even ones you chose. Feeling uncertain partway through this workbook is a normal part of the process, not a sign you're doing it wrong. Work through it at your own pace, and consider talking it through with someone you trust alongside using it.

1. Career Identity Exploration

Career identity is bigger than a job title. During a transition, it's common to feel a real loss of identity, not just a loss of role, especially if you've held one title or one kind of work for a long time. This section separates what's genuinely part of who you are professionally from what was really just tied to your last specific job.

Reflection Questions

- What has been true about how you work across every role you've held, regardless of title or industry?
- If you removed your job title entirely, how would you describe what you actually do and how you do it?
- What parts of your professional identity feel like they belong to you, versus parts that were really about your last specific employer or role?
- What do you want to be true about your professional identity going forward, that may not have been fully true before?

Your Notes

Career Identity Statement

Complete: "Regardless of my next role, I am someone who _____." Write 2-3 versions and pick the one that feels most true, not most impressive.

2. Values Alignment Check

Values here means what genuinely matters to you in how you work and what you work on — not what you think should matter, or what would sound good in an interview. The distinction matters: a career built around inherited or borrowed values tends to feel hollow even when it looks successful from outside.

Identifying Your Real Values

Recall 2-3 specific moments of genuine job satisfaction, and 2-3 of genuine dissatisfaction.

Moment	Satisfying or Dissatisfying?	What Value Was Honored or Violated?
Example: Led a project with full autonomy over approach	Satisfying	Autonomy

Your Top Five Values

In your own words, not from a fixed list — the value that matters is the one you'd actually name yourself.

Value	How Aligned Is My Current Situation? (1-5)
1.	
2.	
3.	
4.	
5.	

3. Skills Audit Framework

Not every skill you're competent at should be central to your next role. This framework sorts skills by two dimensions: how good you are at them, and how much you actually enjoy using them — a skill can be strong and still not worth building a career around if it drains you.

Quadrant	Meaning	What to Do With It
Strong + Enjoy	Genuine strengths — your best work happens here	Leverage deliberately; look for roles that center these
Strong + Don't Enjoy	Competent but draining — useful occasionally, not as a core focus	Deploy sparingly; delegate or minimize where you can
Developing + Enjoy	Genuine interest, not yet matched by strength	Worth investing in developing, since the motivation is real
Weak + Don't Enjoy	Neither ability nor interest	Avoid centering your next role around this; partner or outsource instead

Your Skills Audit

List your skills, then sort each into one of the four quadrants above.

Skill	Quadrant
Example: Public speaking	Strong + Enjoy

4. Options Generation Guide

Generate broadly before narrowing. The most common mistake in this stage is filtering to “realistic” options too early, which quietly eliminates good possibilities before you've actually evaluated them against what matters to you.

Step 1: Brainstorm Without Judgment

List at least 8-10 possible directions, using your identity, values, and skills work above as inspiration. Include at least 2-3 options that feel unrealistic or unlikely — don't filter yet.

Step 2: Apply Filters to Narrow

Once you have a broad list, evaluate your top candidates against these filters.

Option	Values Fit (1-5)	Skills Fit (1-5)	Feasibility (1-5)	Overall Interest (1-5)
Example: Move into a coaching-focused role	5	4	3	5

A high-feasibility option with low values fit will likely feel hollow again eventually; a high-values-fit option with low feasibility may need a bridge step rather than being ruled out entirely.

5. Action Planning Template

Turn your top 1-2 options from Section 4 into concrete next steps. A plan with no specific action and no timeline tends to stay a good idea indefinitely rather than becoming a real transition.

Goal	Specific Action	Timeline	Support Needed	How I'll Know
Example: Explore coaching-focused roles	Have 3 informational conversations with people already in this kind of role	Next 4 weeks	Introductions from my network	I have enough real information to decide whether to pursue further

First Step

What is the single next action you'll take, and by when?

Revisit this workbook every few weeks as you learn more — options generation and action planning both tend to sharpen with real information from actual conversations and research, not just further reflection alone.